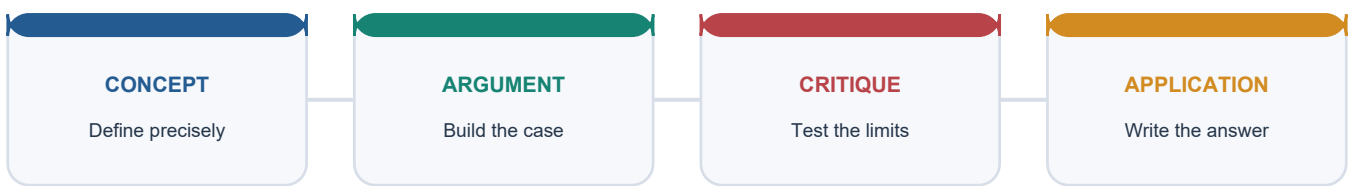


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Parliament - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Parliament - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs

Answer rotation: ABCD repeated eight times. Each question contains four substantive option-specific explanations and one unique question-specific Examiner trap.

MCQ 1. Article 79 composition

Under Article 79, Parliament consists of:

A. President, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha B. Prime Minister, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha C. President and Lok Sabha only D. Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha only

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Article 79 makes the President an integral component with both Houses.
- **B:** Incorrect: the Prime Minister leads government but is not a separate component of Parliament.
- **C:** Incorrect: excluding Rajya Sabha removes the constitutionally created Council of States.
- **D:** Incorrect: the two Houses alone omit the President from the legislative institution.

Examiner trap 1: The trap turns 'not a member of either House' into 'not part of Parliament'.

MCQ 2. Rajya Sabha election

How are elected State representatives to Rajya Sabha chosen?

A. Direct FPTP by State voters B. Proportional representation by single transferable vote through elected MLAs C. List voting by all members of the State Legislature D. Nomination by the Governor

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: direct territorial election belongs to Lok Sabha.
- **B:** Correct: elected MLAs vote through proportional representation by single transferable vote.
- **C:** Incorrect: the electorate excludes Legislative Council members and the method is not closed-list PR.
- **D:** Incorrect: Governors do not nominate the elected State component.

Examiner trap 2: The electorate is elected MLAs, not the whole State Legislature.

MCQ 3. Lok Sabha Emergency extension

During a national emergency, Parliament may extend Lok Sabha's term:

A. once for the entire emergency B. for six months at a time without an outer limit C. one year at a time, not beyond six months after the emergency ends D. only after Rajya Sabha is dissolved

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Article 83 permits repeated annual extensions while the emergency operates.
- **B:** Incorrect: the extension unit is one year, with a six-month post-emergency outer limit.
- **C:** Correct: both the annual unit and final six-month ceiling must be stated.
- **D:** Incorrect: Rajya Sabha is a continuing House and is never dissolved.

Examiner trap 3: UPSC often swaps the one-year extension with the six-month terminal limit.

MCQ 4. Seat-freeze trigger

Which statement correctly describes the present constitutional readjustment gate?

A. Readjustment automatically began on 1 January 2026. B. The 87th Amendment permanently prohibited changing State seat totals. C. Only Census conduct, not publication, is constitutionally relevant. D. Relevant figures of the first census taken after 2026 must be published before the deferred readjustment opens.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the date 2026 is not self-executing.
- **B:** Incorrect: the 87th Amendment changed the census basis for boundary work without creating a permanent ban.
- **C:** Incorrect: publication of relevant figures is part of the constitutional wording.
- **D:** Correct: the 84th Amendment preserved the publication-linked gate.

Examiner trap 4: Do not convert 'after 2026' into 'in 2026'.

MCQ 5. Article 84 qualification

Which is a constitutional qualification for Parliament membership?

A. Citizenship of India B. A university degree C. Ten years' residence in the represented State D. Prior service in a legislature

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: citizenship is expressly required alongside age, oath-related and statutory conditions.
- **B:** Incorrect: the Constitution prescribes no degree requirement.
- **C:** Incorrect: no such ten-year constitutional residence test exists.
- **D:** Incorrect: legislative experience is politically relevant but legally unnecessary.

Examiner trap 5: Statutory qualifications may supplement Article 84, but educational and experience conditions are not implied.

MCQ 6. Article 103 forum

Who decides whether a sitting MP incurred an Article 102(1) disqualification?

- A. Speaker acting without another institution B. President after obtaining the Election Commission's opinion C. Supreme Court in original jurisdiction D. Returning Officer after the election

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the Speaker's separate Tenth Schedule jurisdiction must not be imported.
- **B:** Correct: Article 103 creates the President-ECI route.
- **C:** Incorrect: courts may review but do not replace the first-instance constitutional forum.
- **D:** Incorrect: a returning officer handles candidature-stage issues, not this later reference.

Examiner trap 6: Identify whether the issue is Article 102(1), defection or election validity before naming the forum.

MCQ 7. Article 101 absence

A House may declare an MP's seat vacant for unauthorised absence of:

- A. thirty calendar days B. forty-five sittings C. sixty days calculated with Article 101's excluded periods D. six consecutive months in every case

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: thirty days is not the constitutional period.
- **B:** Incorrect: Article 101 does not use forty-five sittings.
- **C:** Correct: sixty days applies subject to constitutionally excluded adjournment/prorogation periods.
- **D:** Incorrect: six months is the Article 85 session-gap ceiling, not the absence rule.

Examiner trap 7: The distractor borrows six months from summoning law.

MCQ 8. Article 85

Article 85 constitutionally requires that:

- A. three named sessions be held annually B. Parliament sit for at least 100 days C. both Houses always meet simultaneously D. six months shall not intervene between the last sitting of one session and first sitting of the next

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Budget, Monsoon and Winter are conventional labels.
- **B:** Incorrect: no constitutional minimum sitting-day number is written.
- **C:** Incorrect: Houses may have different sitting arrangements.
- **D:** Correct: the inter-session ceiling is the textual safeguard.

Examiner trap 8: At least two sessions is an inference from the interval rule, not the Article's wording.

MCQ 9. Quorum

Until Parliament otherwise provides, Article 100 fixes quorum at:

A. one-tenth of the total number of members of the House B. one-third of sanctioned strength C. fifty members in either House D. a majority of members present

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: one-tenth is the constitutional fraction.
- **B:** Incorrect: one-third is associated with Rajya Sabha retirement, not quorum.
- **C:** Incorrect: the Houses do not share a fixed fifty-member quorum.
- **D:** Incorrect: present members cannot define quorum circularly.

Examiner trap 9: Keep quorum separate from the majority needed to decide an ordinary question.

MCQ 10. Article 88 participation

A Rajya Sabha minister in Lok Sabha may:

A. vote only on Money Bills B. speak and participate but vote only through House membership C. neither speak nor join a committee D. cast one vote in each House

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Article 88 creates no special financial vote.
- **B:** Correct: voice extends across Houses; voting follows membership.
- **C:** Incorrect: participation expressly includes relevant committees.
- **D:** Incorrect: ministerial office never creates dual-House membership.

Examiner trap 10: Article 88 enlarges participation, not the electorate of either House.

MCQ 11. Speaker removal sitting

While the Speaker's removal resolution is under consideration, which combination is correct?

A. Speaker presides and has only a casting vote B. Speaker cannot speak or vote C. Speaker does not preside, may vote in the first instance, and has no casting vote D. Deputy Speaker must also leave the House

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Article 96 removes the Speaker from the chair for this proceeding.
- **B:** Incorrect: the Speaker retains speech and first-instance voting rights.
- **C:** Correct: this balances participation with conflict-of-interest control.
- **D:** Incorrect: no automatic exclusion of the Deputy Speaker follows.

Examiner trap 11: The special voting rule reverses the Speaker's ordinary no-first-vote/casting-vote position.

MCQ 12. Rajya Sabha Chairman

Which statement about the Rajya Sabha Chairman is correct?

A. The Chairman is elected from Rajya Sabha members. B. The Chairman votes in the first instance on every question. C. The Chairman continues as an MP after Vice-Presidential resignation. D. The Vice-President is ex officio Chairman but is not a Rajya Sabha member.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Rajya Sabha elects the Deputy Chairman, not the Chairman.
- **B:** Incorrect: the Chairman ordinarily has only a casting vote on equality.
- **C:** Incorrect: the office flows from the Vice-Presidency, not House membership.
- **D:** Correct: Article 64 and Article 89 create the ex officio arrangement.

Examiner trap 12: Do not describe the Vice-President as the presiding 'member' of Rajya Sabha.

MCQ 13. Privilege and bribery

What did *Sita Soren v. Union of India* (2024) establish?

A. Accepting a bribe for a legislative speech or vote is not immunised by Articles 105/194. B. All parliamentary speech can be prosecuted. C. Privilege provisions were struck down. D. Only the House may investigate bribery.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the offence of bribery is independent of the protected legislative act.
- **B:** Incorrect: bona fide speech and voting immunity survives.
- **C:** Incorrect: the Court interpreted privilege; it did not invalidate the Articles.
- **D:** Incorrect: ordinary criminal law and courts remain available.

Examiner trap 13: The holding narrows corruption immunity without destroying deliberative immunity.

MCQ 14. Question Hour

Which pairing is correct?

A. Starred-written-no supplementaries B. Unstarred-written-no supplementaries C. Short-notice-written only D. Zero Hour-formally codified first hour

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: starred questions are answered orally and permit supplementaries.
- **B:** Correct: unstarred questions create a written record without oral follow-up.
- **C:** Incorrect: short-notice questions are ordinarily oral on urgent matters.
- **D:** Incorrect: Zero Hour is an informal Indian innovation, not the rule-based first hour.

Examiner trap 14: The answer turns on reply mode and follow-up, not on urgency alone.

MCQ 15. No-confidence motion

Which statement is correct about a no-confidence motion?

A. It may be moved in either House. B. It must list charges against each minister. C. It is a Lok Sabha device requiring fifty members to support leave and tests the Council collectively. D. Its admission itself compels resignation.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: collective responsibility is to Lok Sabha.
- **B:** Incorrect: reasons need not be stated for no-confidence.
- **C:** Correct: Rule 198 admission and Article 75(3) consequence must be combined.
- **D:** Incorrect: only passage, not admission, determines political survival.

Examiner trap 15: Do not merge censure's reasoned criticism with no-confidence's bare majority test.

MCQ 16. Resolution distinction

Which statement best distinguishes a resolution?

A. Every procedural motion is a resolution. B. A resolution can never arise under a statute. C. A resolution necessarily removes the government. D. A resolution is a self-contained substantive expression of House opinion or decision; every resolution is a motion, but not every motion is a resolution.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: many motions merely regulate procedure.
- **B:** Incorrect: statutory resolutions are a recognised category.
- **C:** Incorrect: most resolutions do not test confidence.
- **D:** Correct: the hierarchy captures both form and consequence.

Examiner trap 16: UPSC may use 'motion' as the wider genus and 'resolution' as a substantive species.

MCQ 17. Private Member's Bill

A Private Member's Bill is:

A. introduced by an MP who is not a minister and processed under specially allotted House business B. introduced only by a recognised opposition leader C. exempt from presidential assent D. incapable of becoming law

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: sponsor status, not party, defines private-member business.
- **B:** Incorrect: government-party backbenchers may also be private members.
- **C:** Incorrect: enactment still requires the ordinary constitutional completion route.
- **D:** Incorrect: rarity of enactment is political practice, not legal incapacity.

Examiner trap 17: Private member means non-minister, not opposition member.

MCQ 18. Ordinary Bill origin

An ordinary Union Bill may constitutionally originate:

A. only in Lok Sabha B. in either House, subject to any specific constitutional recommendation requirement C. only after joint-committee scrutiny D. only when introduced by a minister

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Lok Sabha-only origin is a special financial rule.
- **B:** Correct: Article 107 permits either-House origin for ordinary legislation.
- **C:** Incorrect: committee scrutiny is not an automatic precondition.
- **D:** Incorrect: private members may introduce Bills.

Examiner trap 18: Classify the Bill before applying an origin restriction.

MCQ 19. Money Bill content

For a Bill to be a Money Bill under Article 110, it must:

A. contain at least one taxation clause regardless of other content B. be titled a Finance Bill C. contain only listed Article 110 matters and incidental provisions D. be passed at a joint sitting

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: unrelated substantive provisions defeat the 'only' requirement.
- **B:** Incorrect: title does not determine constitutional classification.
- **C:** Correct: exclusivity is the controlling textual firewall.
- **D:** Incorrect: no joint sitting exists for Money Bills.

Examiner trap 19: A financial subject somewhere in the Bill is insufficient.

MCQ 20. Financial Bill-II

Which statement correctly describes an Article 117(3) Financial Bill?

A. It is a Money Bill. B. It can originate only in Lok Sabha. C. Rajya Sabha may only recommend changes. D. It may originate in either House, but presidential recommendation is required before consideration.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it contains expenditure implications without being confined to Article 110.
- **B:** Incorrect: the Lok Sabha-only rule belongs to clause (1).
- **C:** Incorrect: both Houses otherwise have ordinary-Bill powers.
- **D:** Correct: recommendation timing is before consideration.

Examiner trap 20: Do not apply Financial Bill-I restrictions to Financial Bill-II.

MCQ 21. Appropriation Bill

What is the central function of an Appropriation Bill?

A. To authorise withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund of India for voted grants and charged expenditure B. To impose every tax announced in the Budget C. To obtain Rajya Sabha's vote on demands for grants D. To approve CAG reports

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Article 114 converts parliamentary financial approval into lawful withdrawal authority.
- **B:** Incorrect: taxation measures ordinarily travel through finance legislation.
- **C:** Incorrect: demands for grants are voted only in Lok Sabha.
- **D:** Incorrect: PAC examines CAG material after expenditure.

Examiner trap 21: Budget presentation and grant voting still do not permit withdrawal without appropriation.

MCQ 22. Joint-sitting trigger

Which is an Article 108 deadlock trigger for an eligible Bill?

A. President returns the Bill once. B. The second House rejects it or the Houses finally disagree on amendments. C. A State Legislature refuses ratification. D. Rajya Sabha recommends changes to a Money Bill.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: presidential reconsideration is governed by Article 111.
- **B:** Correct: rejection and final disagreement are express deadlock routes.
- **C:** Incorrect: State ratification belongs to Article 368 and has no joint sitting.
- **D:** Incorrect: Money Bill recommendations are handled under Article 109.

Examiner trap 22: Joint sitting resolves inter-House ordinary-law deadlock, not every failed consent.

MCQ 23. Bill lapse

Which Bill lapses on Lok Sabha dissolution?

A. A Bill passed by both Houses awaiting assent B. A Rajya-Sabha-origin Bill still pending only in Rajya Sabha C. A Bill passed by Lok Sabha and pending in Rajya Sabha D. A Bill for which joint-sitting intention was notified before dissolution

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: bicameral passage preserves the Bill for assent.
- **B:** Incorrect: it has not acquired an expired Lok Sabha mandate.
- **C:** Correct: unfinished Lok Sabha passage lapses with that House.
- **D:** Incorrect: prior joint-sitting notification prevents lapse.

Examiner trap 23: Track whether the dissolved Lok Sabha had passed the Bill.

MCQ 24. Constitution Amendment Bill

Which statement about an Article 368 Bill is correct?

A. It must originate in Lok Sabha. B. A simple majority in a joint sitting can pass it. C. The President may return it for reconsideration. D. Each House must separately pass the required special majority; no joint sitting cures failure.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: either House may introduce it.
- **B:** Incorrect: Article 108 does not apply.
- **C:** Incorrect: after valid passage the President shall give assent.
- **D:** Correct: bicameral special consent is independently required.

Examiner trap 24: An amendment Bill is not an ordinary Bill with a higher combined vote.

MCQ 25. Charged expenditure

Charged expenditure on the Consolidated Fund of India:

A. may be discussed but is not submitted to Lok Sabha vote B. cannot even be discussed C. is voted by Rajya Sabha alone D. requires a cut motion

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: Article 113 preserves discussion while withholding the grant vote.
- **B:** Incorrect: non-votable does not mean non-discussable.
- **C:** Incorrect: Rajya Sabha does not vote demands for grants.
- **D:** Incorrect: cut motions apply to votable demands.

Examiner trap 25: UPSC tests the difference between discussion and voting.

MCQ 26. Public Accounts Committee

Which description of the PAC is correct?

A. Thirty Lok Sabha members examining estimates B. Twenty-two members examining CAG-linked accounts; Opposition chair is a convention C. Thirty-one members examining ministry Bills D. A minister-chaired consultative body

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: that composition and forward-looking function belong to Estimates Committee.
- **B:** Correct: 15 Lok Sabha and 7 Rajya Sabha members conduct post-expenditure scrutiny.
- **C:** Incorrect: 31-member structures describe DRSCs.
- **D:** Incorrect: ministers cannot sit on the financial committees.

Examiner trap 26: Opposition chairmanship is convention, while composition and function come from rules.

MCQ 27. Estimates Committee

Which feature belongs to the Estimates Committee?

A. Seven Rajya Sabha members B. Post-audit examination of CAG reports C. Thirty Lok Sabha-only members examining economy and efficiency in estimates D. Review of delegated rules

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Rajya Sabha has no representation on this committee.
- **B:** Incorrect: that is the PAC's principal audit route.
- **C:** Correct: it is the largest financial committee and looks forward to economies.
- **D:** Incorrect: subordinate legislation has a separate scrutiny committee.

Examiner trap 27: Do not swap pre-expenditure economy review with post-expenditure audit.

MCQ 28. Subordinate legislation

The Committee on Subordinate Legislation principally examines whether:

A. the Council retains confidence B. CAG certified expenditure C. a Bill should be treated as a Money Bill D. rules and regulations remain within the parent Act and proper delegated authority

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: confidence belongs to the House floor.
- **B:** Incorrect: PAC handles CAG-linked financial scrutiny.
- **C:** Incorrect: Money Bill certification belongs to the Speaker.
- **D:** Correct: the committee checks delegated-law legality and propriety.

Examiner trap 28: The committee scrutinises executive-made detail after legislative delegation.

MCQ 29. Article 249

A valid Rajya Sabha resolution under Article 249 enables:

A. Parliament to legislate temporarily on a State List matter in the national interest B. Rajya Sabha to amend the State List permanently C. the President to dissolve a State Assembly D. creation of an All India Service

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the resolution opens a time-bound national-interest legislative window.
- **B:** Incorrect: constitutional distribution is not permanently rewritten.
- **C:** Incorrect: dissolution questions arise under other provisions.
- **D:** Incorrect: service creation is Article 312.

Examiner trap 29: Article 249 shifts legislative competence temporarily, not ownership of the subject.

MCQ 30. Article 312

Article 312 requires which gateway for creating a new All India Service?

A. Lok Sabha simple majority B. Rajya Sabha resolution by two-thirds of members present and voting in the national interest C. Approval by every State Legislature D. A joint sitting

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the special federal gateway is located in Rajya Sabha.
- **B:** Correct: the present-and-voting supermajority precedes parliamentary law.
- **C:** Incorrect: unanimous State ratification is not required.
- **D:** Incorrect: Article 108 is irrelevant.

Examiner trap 30: Keep the Article 312 gateway distinct from the later law that creates the service.

MCQ 31. Ordinance reassembly

If the Houses reassemble on different dates, the six-week ordinance period is counted from:

A. the earlier House's date B. the date of promulgation C. the later reassembly date D. the next Budget Session

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the Constitution uses the later date for the combined parliamentary opportunity.
- **B:** Incorrect: promulgation begins operation but not the six-week reassembly clock.
- **C:** Correct: the later date controls.
- **D:** Incorrect: conventional session labels do not govern Article 123 expiry.

Examiner trap 31: The two-House calculation is a classic close-option trap.

MCQ 32. Article 122

Which statement best states Article 122?

A. It bars all judicial review of parliamentary action. B. It makes every Speaker ruling final against Fundamental Rights. C. It allows courts to supervise daily House procedure. D. It protects proceedings from challenge for mere procedural irregularity while leaving substantive constitutional illegality reviewable.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Raja Ram Pal rejects blanket immunity.
- **B:** Incorrect: constitutional violations remain reviewable.
- **C:** Incorrect: courts do not manage ordinary parliamentary procedure.
- **D:** Correct: procedural autonomy and constitutional supremacy coexist.

Examiner trap 32: Irregularity is not the same as illegality or unconstitutionality.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Answer-writing control

Marks	Maximum length	Minimum viable architecture
10	150 words	Direct thesis -> two mechanisms -> named evidence -> qualification -> verdict
15	250 words	Define boundary -> 4-5 dimensions -> case/committee/article evidence -> counterpoint -> reform/verdict
20	250 words	Constitutional map -> institutional operation -> criticism and counter-evidence -> reforms -> qualified conclusion

Mandatory paragraph logic: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification. A list of devices without explaining how they change executive incentives is not analysis.

Audited routed Prelims PYQs

[FACT] The question numbers and neutral demands below follow the repository's audited local official-paper routing ledgers. Older scanned booklets are recorded without inventing an answer key. The 2024-2025 letters are printed only because final official Set-A keys are held locally; the 2026 key is provisional and is therefore withheld.

PYQ-P1. 2018 Prelims - routed question 1

Verified demand: First Lok Sabha opposition party and Leader of Opposition history.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 1 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P2. 2018 Prelims - routed question 20

Verified demand: Parliamentary committee that scrutinises delegated legislation.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 2 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P3. 2018 Prelims - routed question 31

Verified demand: Constitutional provisions and definition of a Money Bill.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 3 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P4. 2019 Prelims - routed question 49

Verified demand: Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act and office of profit.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 4 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P5. 2019 Prelims - routed question 69

Verified demand: Parliamentary committees reviewing independent sector regulators.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 5 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P6. 2020 Prelims - routed question 2

Verified demand: Area in which Rajya Sabha has power equal to Lok Sabha.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 6 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P7. 2020 Prelims - routed question 3

Verified demand: MPLADS durable assets, SC/ST allocation and carry-forward rules.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 7 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P8. 2020 Prelims - routed question 20

Verified demand: Presidential summoning and the constitutional session interval.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 8 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P9. 2022 Prelims - routed question 15

Verified demand: Exclusive constitutional powers of Lok Sabha.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 9 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P10. 2022 Prelims - routed question 20

Verified demand: Election and rulings of the Deputy Speaker of Lok Sabha.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 10 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P11. 2023 Prelims - routed question 37

Verified demand: Finance Bill and Money Bill: Rajya Sabha powers and joint sitting.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 11 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P12. 2024 Prelims - routed question 68

Verified demand: Money Bill: Article 109, Rajya Sabha recommendation and non-binding changes.

Official Set-A answer: C.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 12 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P13. 2024 Prelims - routed question 80

Verified demand: Lok Sabha Ethics Committee: ad hoc origin, complaint route and sub judice bar.

Official Set-A answer: C.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 13 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P14. 2024 Prelims - routed question 81

Verified demand: Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam: commencement, duration and SC-women sub-reservation.

Official Set-A answer: C.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 14 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P15. 2024 Prelims - routed question 93

Verified demand: Speaker during consideration of a removal resolution.

Official Set-A answer: A.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 15 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P16. 2024 Prelims - routed question 94

Verified demand: Bills that lapse on dissolution of Lok Sabha.

Official Set-A answer: B.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 16 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P17. 2024 Prelims - routed question 95

Verified demand: Prorogation and dissolution by the President on ministerial advice.

Official Set-A answer: C.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 17 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P18. 2025 Prelims - routed question 87

Verified demand: Speaker's post-dissolution continuity, party membership and removal majority.

Official Set-A answer: C.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 18 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P19. 2026 Prelims - routed question 58

Verified demand: Starred/unstarred questions and supplementary questions in Parliament.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 19 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

PYQ-P20. 2026 Prelims - routed question 59

Verified demand: Parliamentary Committee on Welfare of Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Answer route: Use the Parliament rule taught in Sessions 20 and state the decisive close-option distinction rather than guessing from political practice.

Eight directly routed Mains PYQs with model answers

Provenance rule: The seven 2018-2023 demands are routed by the audited Core owner. The 2024 GS-II Q3 wording is verified in the cross-owned Polity 11/16 packages. Neutral wording is used where exact UPSC wording has not been independently reproduced here.

PYQ-M1. 2018 GS-II Q4 - Usefulness of parliamentary committees, especially the Estimates Committee

Demand decoding

- "Discuss" requires functions, usefulness, limitations and a balanced conclusion.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** use three institutional units, not a catalogue of every committee.

Model answer

Claim: Parliamentary committees are indispensable "working rooms" of Parliament because they preserve detailed scrutiny when plenary time is scarce.

Named evidence: The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members**, excludes ministers and examines budget estimates for economy, efficiency and administrative improvement. It complements the **PAC**, which audits CAG findings after expenditure, and **CoPU**, which specialises in public undertakings. The **24 DRSCs**, each with 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha members, examine demands for grants, referred Bills and ministry reports.

Analysis: Small membership, evidence-taking, continuity and less theatrical party competition allow technical and often cross-party scrutiny. Estimates scrutiny is preventive: it asks whether public money can be spent better before audit identifies failure.

Qualification: Reports are advisory; attendance, research support and Bill referral vary. Estimates recommendations cannot themselves alter grants.

Verdict: Committees do not replace the House, but they make its financial and legislative control credible. Routine referral and stronger follow-up would increase their usefulness.

Examiner note: Exact Estimates-PAC-CoPU differentiation, DRSC evidence and one limitation make this complete rather than descriptive.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named committee units plus a qualified verdict.

Why this earns marks: Exact committee differentiation, causal usefulness and a bounded advisory-status verdict satisfy the directive.

How to improve this answer: If compressed, retain Estimates 30 LS-only, PAC-CAG, one DRSC function and the advisory/referral limit; drop the wider committee catalogue.

PYQ-M2. 2019 GS-II Q15 - Decline of the individual parliamentarian and debate quality

Demand decoding

- "Discuss" requires mechanisms causing decline, surviving opportunities and reforms.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** separate member autonomy, House time and scrutiny quality.

Model answer

Claim: The individual MP's law-making role has declined because party and executive institutions increasingly determine both the vote and the agenda.

Named evidence and analysis: First, the **Tenth Schedule** makes defiance of a party direction potentially disqualifying. This stabilises government but converts many legislative choices into party commands. Second, the executive controls most government business and drafting; limited sitting time, disruption and the **guillotine** can pass demands without discussion. Third, fewer or selective referrals to **DRSCs** remove the main site for clause-level, evidence-based scrutiny. Fourth, ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** Money Bill route can compress prior bicameral deliberation. Finally, the rarity of successful Private Members' Bills signals limited non-government law-making space.

Counter-evidence: MPs still use starred questions, Zero Hour, motions, committee reports, amendments and constituency knowledge. Rajya Sabha scrutiny and opposition-led PAC work can produce institutional effects even without defeating the government.

Qualification: Decline varies with majority size, coalition politics, committee referral and presiding-officer practice; it is not a constitutional disappearance of the MP.

Verdict: The parliamentarian has shifted from autonomous law-maker toward party-linked scrutiniser. Predictable sittings, default committee referral and a whip confined to confidence/core finance would restore deliberation without destabilising government.

Examiner note: The answer explains the causal chain and acknowledges surviving agency; it does not confuse low autonomy with legal powerlessness.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 5 mechanisms, 2 counter-instruments and 3 reforms.

Why this earns marks: The answer explains the whip-agenda-time causal chain, preserves surviving MP agency and closes with feasible reforms.

How to improve this answer: For 150 words, keep Tenth Schedule, executive agenda, one scrutiny loss and one reform; for 250 words retain counter-evidence and variation by majority size.

PYQ-M3. 2020 GS-II Q5 - "Once a Speaker, always a Speaker" and objectivity

Demand decoding

- Answer both parts: whether the convention operates in India and its implications for objectivity.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** one institutional contrast, three powers, one reform.

Model answer

Claim: The British convention that a Speaker severs party ties and is normally returned unopposed does not operate in India; therefore neutrality rests more on individual conduct than institutional insulation.

Named evidence: Under **Articles 93-97**, the Speaker controls procedure and discipline. The office also certifies a Money Bill under **Article 110**, presides over an **Article 108** joint sitting and decides Tenth Schedule petitions subject to *Kihoto Hollohan*. The Speaker retains party membership and ordinarily contests again on a party ticket.

Analysis: These high-stakes powers can affect bicameralism, government survival and member status. A party-linked career therefore creates a perception of bias even when a decision is legally defensible. Delayed defection rulings and disputed Money Bill certification intensify the concern.

Qualification: Article 94 continuity after dissolution, charged salary and House removal safeguards provide some independence; party origin does not prove actual partisanship.

Verdict: "Once a Speaker, always a Speaker" is aspirational, not Indian practice. Reasoned rulings, political detachment and independent defection adjudication would make objectivity structural.

Examiner note: Direct convention answer plus powers-mechanism-qualification sequence satisfies both limbs.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named powers and one balanced reform.

Why this earns marks: It answers both the comparative-convention and objectivity limbs through three high-stakes powers and a qualified institutional judgment.

How to improve this answer: Compress to Article 110, Tenth Schedule and party-linked career; improve further by separating perceived bias from proof of bias in one explicit sentence.

PYQ-M4. 2020 GS-II Q14 - Rajya Sabha as a supporting organ

Demand decoding

- "Highlight factors and areas" requires separate treatment of causes and fields of subordination.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** avoid the absolute claim that Rajya Sabha is inferior everywhere.

Model answer

Claim: Rajya Sabha is a supporting chamber in finance and confidence, but a co-equal or distinctive chamber in ordinary law, constitutional amendment and federal protection.

Areas of subordination: Under **Articles 109-110**, it can only recommend changes to a Money Bill within fourteen days. It cannot vote demands for grants, and **Article 75(3)** gives only Lok Sabha the confidence key. In an **Article 108** joint sitting, Lok Sabha's larger numbers usually prevail.

Factors: Direct election gives Lok Sabha stronger popular legitimacy; executive survival is tied to its majority; and disputed use of the Money Bill route can bypass the Upper House. Political disruption and limited referral can further weaken revision.

Counter-evidence: Rajya Sabha has equal power over ordinary Bills and **Article 368** amendments. As a permanent House it supplies continuity. Its two exclusive powers - **Article 249** State List legislation in the national interest and **Article 312** creation of All-India Services - make it a federal gatekeeper. It also shares committee scrutiny and national debate.

Qualification: State representation is population-weighted, not equal-per-State; its federal design is therefore weaker than a senate based on State equality.

Verdict: Rajya Sabha supports Lok Sabha without being subordinate to it. The label is accurate only where the Constitution deliberately prioritises popular control over money and government survival.

Examiner note: Separates "factors" from "areas" and gives a degree-based verdict with Articles 249/312.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 3 subordinate fields, 4 counterweights and one design caveat.

Why this earns marks: The graded equal-unequal-exclusive structure directly answers both factors and areas without reducing Rajya Sabha to a uniformly inferior chamber.

How to improve this answer: Under time pressure use a three-row power matrix, then add Articles 249/312 and the population-weighted federal caveat before the verdict.

PYQ-M5. 2021 GS-II Q4 - Extent of Parliament's executive accountability

Demand decoding

- "To what extent" demands a graded judgment, not a list of devices.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** instruments -> limits -> degree-based verdict.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament possesses a comprehensive accountability toolkit, but its effectiveness is conditional on time, information and party incentives.

Named evidence: Starred questions and supplementaries compel ministerial explanation; Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions expose policy failure. **Article 75(3)** enables Lok Sabha no-confidence control. **Articles 112-114** require budget presentation, voting of grants and appropriation. **PAC-CAG** audit and **DRSC** scrutiny extend control beyond the floor.

Analysis: These instruments cover the full administrative cycle - information, authorisation, ongoing criticism, financial audit and ultimate removal.

Qualification: A secure majority and the Tenth Schedule make government defeat unlikely. Disruptions, the guillotine, limited sitting days, selective committee referral and ordinances can weaken scrutiny.

Verdict: Accountability is constitutionally strong but behaviourally uneven: Parliament usually extracts information and audit, yet only exceptionally threatens executive survival. Protected scrutiny time and stronger committees would narrow the gap.

Examiner note: "Extent" is answered explicitly by distinguishing routine oversight from survival control.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 evidence families and 4 limitations.

Why this earns marks: A clear extent judgment distinguishes routine information/audit control from the exceptional survival sanction.

How to improve this answer: Retain Article 75(3), one financial-control chain, one committee and two operating limits; do not spend words cataloguing every motion.

PYQ-M6. 2021 GS-II Q15 - Working of DRSCs in enforcing executive control

Demand decoding

- "Evaluate" requires criteria: design, performance, weaknesses and final assessment.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** exact composition is essential.

Model answer

Claim: DRSCs are Parliament's most capable instrument of continuous ministry-wise oversight, but they enforce control through information and persuasion rather than binding command.

Named evidence: Introduced as **17 committees in 1993** and restructured to **24 from 2004**, each now has **31 members - 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha**; sixteen are Lok Sabha-secretariat serviced and eight Rajya Sabha-secretariat serviced. Ministers are barred. They examine demands for grants, referred Bills, annual reports and long-term policy.

Analysis: Their smaller forum permits evidence-taking, clause scrutiny, technical learning and cross-party consensus away from floor grandstanding. Demand-for-grants reports connect policy priorities with spending; Bill reports improve legal design; action-taken reports sustain follow-up.

Weaknesses: Referral is not automatic, recommendations are non-binding, terms are only one year, attendance and research support can be weak, and the government may provide delayed or formalistic responses. Major Bills passed without referral show that effectiveness depends on executive and presiding-officer choices.

Qualification: Non-binding status is not uselessness: reasoned reports shape debate, media and later policy, while final law and supply must remain with the House.

Verdict: DRSCs work effectively when used, but are under-used. Default referral, longer specialisation, expert staff and public reasons for bypass would convert potential into systematic control.

Examiner note: Exact 1993/2004 and 21+10 controls, functions and enforceability distinction produce an evaluative answer.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 235-250 words; 4 functions, 5 weaknesses and 4 reforms.

Why this earns marks: Exact 17-to-24 chronology, 21+10 composition, functions and non-binding influence provide evaluative rather than descriptive depth.

How to improve this answer: If shortening, preserve composition, demands/Bill scrutiny, optional referral and one reform; remove generic praise before removing institutional evidence.

PYQ-M7. 2023 GS-II Q16 - Committee structure and role of financial committees

Demand decoding

- "Explain the structure" requires classification before evaluating the financial arm.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** use exact committee compositions.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament's committee system combines permanent subject/House oversight with task-specific inquiry; its financial committees operationalise the constitutional power of the purse.

Structure: **Standing committees** include financial committees, 24 DRSCs, House-management committees and oversight bodies such as Subordinate Legislation, Privileges, Ethics, Government Assurances and Welfare of SCs/STs. **Ad hoc committees** include Select/Joint Committees on Bills and JPCs formed for a specified inquiry.

Named financial evidence: The **PAC** has **22 members (15 LS + 7 RS)**, is conventionally chaired by the Opposition and examines CAG reports after expenditure. The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members only** and seeks economy and administrative improvement before or during expenditure planning. **CoPU** has **22 members (15+7)** and specialises in public undertakings. Ministers are barred from all three.

Analysis: Estimates supplies prospective efficiency scrutiny, PAC retrospective legality/regularity scrutiny and CoPU institution-specific commercial accountability. DRSC examination of demands bridges these stages.

Qualification: Reports are advisory, PAC ordinarily avoids questioning policy itself and referral/follow-up may be weak.

Verdict: The structure substitutes depth for scarce floor time; its financial arm closes the authorisation-audit loop but needs stronger research and action-taken enforcement.

Examiner note: Begins with the required architecture, then explains rather than merely names each financial committee.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; classification plus exact 22/30/22 evidence.

Why this earns marks: Classification precedes the exact financial trio, and prospective, retrospective and undertaking-specific roles are analytically separated.

How to improve this answer: Use a standing-versus-ad-hoc opening, then PAC 15+7, Estimates 30 LS-only and CoPU 15+7; end with advisory-status and follow-up limits.

PYQ-M8. 2024 GS-II Q3 - Cabinet growth and marginalisation of parliamentary supremacy

Demand decoding

- "Elucidate" requires a mechanism showing how cabinet growth affects Parliament.
- "Parliamentary supremacy" must mean effective control/deliberation, not UK-style legal sovereignty.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** three mechanisms, correctives and qualified verdict.

Model answer

Claim: The cabinet remains responsible to Lok Sabha under **Article 75(3)**, yet fusion of executive and legislature can let a disciplined cabinet majority dominate the institution meant to control it.

Named evidence and analysis: The Tenth Schedule whip reduces independent voting; the government controls most Bills and House time; guillotining demands, selective DRSC referral and compressed debate weaken scrutiny. Ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** route can reduce prior legislative and bicameral examination. PMO-centred coordination may add prime-ministerial dominance over cabinet dominance.

Qualification: Parliament still authorises supply, may remove the ministry, asks questions and uses PAC-CAG/DRSC scrutiny. Courts enforce constitutional limits and elections renew responsibility.

Verdict: Cabinet growth has marginalised Parliament's deliberative and control functions, not transferred constitutional sovereignty. Predictable sittings, routine committee scrutiny and narrower whip use can restore responsible fusion.

Examiner note: It clarifies the proposition, proves the mechanism and avoids the sovereignty trap.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 mechanisms, 3 correctives and one reform verdict.

Why this earns marks: The answer links cabinet growth to agenda, whip and time control while retaining constitutional counterweights and a degree-based conclusion.

How to improve this answer: For 150 words, keep Article 75(3), agenda control, whip, committee/Question Hour counterweight and one activation reform; avoid repeating the word dominance.

Six original solved Mains answers

Original Q1 - 10 marks, 150 words

Question: Explain how the constitutional design of parliamentary sessions both enables and limits executive accountability.

Demand decoding: "Explain how" requires a mechanism, not merely definitions. Cover summoning rule, devices and the weak sitting-day floor.

Model solution

Claim: Session design keeps the executive periodically answerable but leaves the intensity of accountability to political control of the calendar.

Named evidence: **Article 85** prevents more than six months between sessions, ensuring at least two annual opportunities for scrutiny. Within sittings, starred questions, supplementaries, Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions demand explanation; **Article 75(3)** allows Lok Sabha to test confidence.

Analysis: Periodic summoning prevents indefinite executive rule without Parliament, while oral questions and motions convert presence into public responsibility.

Qualification: The Constitution fixes no minimum sitting days and does not mandate three named sessions. Executive influence over summoning, disruption and loss of Question Hour may satisfy Article 85 while weakening real scrutiny.

Verdict: The design guarantees recurrence, not adequacy. A predictable calendar and protected accountability time would convert the six-month floor into effective control.

Examiner comment: Strong because Article 85 is linked to actual devices and its design limitation, rather than treated as a calendar fact.

Why this earns marks: Direct thesis; two Articles; mechanism; qualification; feasible reform within 150-word scale.

How to improve this answer: If space is tight, retain Article 85, two live accountability devices and the no-minimum-sitting-days qualification; state the reform as protected scrutiny time.

Original Q2 - 10 marks, 150 words

Question: Legislative privilege is a functional immunity, not a personal impunity. Discuss with reference to *Sita Soren (2024)*.

Demand decoding: Define function, apply the case and preserve the surviving immunity.

Model solution

Claim: Article 105 protects fearless legislative functioning, not private criminal bargains.

Named evidence: It immunises proceedings for speech and vote in Parliament and protects authorised parliamentary publication. Yet in *Sita Soren (2024) v. Union of India (2024)* a unanimous seven-judge Bench overruled *P.V. Narasimha Rao* and held that accepting a bribe for a speech or vote attracts no Article 105/194 immunity; bribery is complete on acceptance.

Analysis: The functional-nexus test explains the distinction: debate and voting require autonomy from external litigation, whereas a bribe subverts rather than enables that function.

Qualification: The judgment did not expose bona fide speeches or votes to ordinary suits. Nor does judicial review authorise courts to manage routine House procedure.

Verdict: Privilege remains a shield for institutional independence, but *Sita Soren (2024)* correctly denies its conversion into a personal criminal safe harbour.

Examiner comment: Uses exact case proposition and avoids the frequent overstatement that all speech immunity has disappeared.

Why this earns marks: Definition, Article, overruled precedent, functional analysis and precise qualification.

How to improve this answer: Keep the functional-nexus test, the overruled precedent and the acceptance-completes-bribery rule; do not imply that ordinary speech immunity disappeared.

Original Q3 - 15 marks, 250 words

Question: The Money Bill procedure is necessary for popular control of finance but vulnerable to bicameral bypass. Critically examine.

Demand decoding: "Critically examine" requires the rationale, misuse risk, case law and a bounded verdict.

Model solution

Claim: Articles 109-110 legitimately privilege the directly elected Lok Sabha in narrowly fiscal legislation, but overbroad certification can convert financial primacy into general legislative supremacy.

Named evidence: A Money Bill must contain **only** Article 110(1)(a)-(g) matters and incidental provisions. It begins in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation; Rajya Sabha may only recommend within fourteen days, and no joint sitting exists. The Speaker certifies it, with Article 110 calling the decision final.

Analysis: This design protects supply and taxation from Upper-House obstruction and aligns financial responsibility with the House that can dismiss the ministry. However, classification also removes Rajya Sabha's amendment veto. Adding substantial non-fiscal provisions therefore harms bicameralism and federal revision.

Judicial evidence: *Puttaswamy (Aadhaar)*, 2018 upheld the Aadhaar route by 4:1; *Rojer Mathew v. South Indian Bank (2019)* doubted the reasoning and referred the larger question to seven judges.

Qualification: Textual finality is not ordinary merits appeal, yet narrow constitutional review for illegality/misuse remains. As of 7 September 2026 no visible final larger-Bench resolution was located.

Verdict: Popular financial control requires the special procedure, but constitutional fidelity requires strict enforcement of "only", reasoned certification and narrow review.

Examiner comment: Balances democratic rationale and federal cost, uses both leading cases and preserves current-status caution.

Why this earns marks: Article -> mechanism -> consequence -> cases -> qualification -> reform verdict.

How to improve this answer: Use a two-column rationale-versus-bypass frame; quote Article 110 only, preserve the pending-status date and avoid presenting review as a merits appeal.

Original Q4 - 15 marks, 250 words

Question: Parliament's power of the purse is exercised through a chain, not a single budget vote. Analyse.

Demand decoding: Build the complete authorisation-to-audit cycle and identify weak links.

Model solution

Claim: Financial control is a sequence of disclosure, deliberation, authorisation, expenditure and audit rather than one annual approval.

Named evidence and analysis: **Article 112** requires the Annual Financial Statement and distinguishes charged from voted expenditure. Under **Article 113**, Lok Sabha alone votes demands for grants, using Policy, Economy and Token Cut Motions. DRSCs examine ministry demands before voting, though the **guillotine** may pass undiscussed demands. **Article 114** then requires an Appropriation Act before withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund, while the Finance Bill enacts taxation. **Articles 115-116** provide supplementary, additional, excess grants, vote on account, vote of credit and exceptional grants. After spending, the **CAG** audits and the **PAC** examines reports; excess expenditure is regularised only after this post-facto scrutiny.

Qualification: Rajya Sabha discusses but does not vote demands. Charged expenditure is discussed but not voted. Public Account withdrawal is outside appropriation. Majority discipline makes cut-motion success rare, and PAC review is retrospective.

Verdict: The chain is constitutionally comprehensive but only as strong as DRSC time, grant debate and audit follow-up. Protecting these stages matters more than ritual budget passage.

Examiner comment: The answer maps the entire cycle and differentiates charged expenditure, Public Account and Rajya Sabha's role.

Why this earns marks: Six named constitutional/institutional units linked analytically rather than listed.

How to improve this answer: Draw the authorisation-to-audit chain first, then add charged expenditure and Public Account as the two highest-value distinctions; omit minor grant taxonomy if necessary.

Original Q5 - 20 marks, 250 words

Question: Delimitation after the population freeze is simultaneously a democratic-equality and a federal-fairness problem. Examine with reference to the women's reservation trigger.

Demand decoding: Examine both normative claims, then integrate Article 334A and current controls.

Model solution

Claim: Restoring population-proportional representation answers malapportionment but may penalise States that reduced fertility, making delimitation a federal bargain rather than a cartographic exercise.

Named evidence: **Article 81(2)(a)** links State seats to population. The **42nd Amendment** froze allocation on 1971 figures; the **84th Amendment** extended readjustment until publication of the first post-2026 census figures; the **87th** enabled 2001-based boundary readjustment. Because Rajya Sabha is population-weighted rather than equal-per-State, low-growth States lack a US-Senate-type counterweight.

Women's-reservation link: The **106th Amendment** inserted Articles 330A, 332A and 334A. It commenced on **16 April 2026**, but Article 334A requires publication of relevant first post-commencement census figures and delimitation before reservation operates. Census 2027 is the trigger census, yet publication and delimitation dates are unknown.

Counterpoint: Permanent under-representation of populous citizens is itself a democratic deficit; the freeze cannot substitute forever for representation.

Qualification: The defeated 131st Amendment Bill's 850 ceiling and 2011 basis are not law. No State or women's-seat projection is valid.

Verdict: Reform must reconcile vote equality with demographic-performance fairness, possibly through negotiated House design, without forecasting an outcome the Constitution has not yet produced.

Examiner comment: Integrates static freeze law, federal theory and the exact commenced-but-not-operational sequence.

Why this earns marks: Balanced normative analysis with Articles, amendments, current trigger and explicit risk controls.

How to improve this answer: Separate democratic equality, federal fairness and Article 334A into three paragraphs; never turn the defeated 850-seat proposal or an unknown publication date into law.

Original Q6 - 20 marks, 250 words

Question: "Parliament is strong in constitutional instruments but weak in their political use." Critically examine and propose reforms.

Demand decoding: Test both halves, cover the full accountability architecture and rank reforms.

Model solution

Claim: Parliament retains formidable powers over law, supply and executive survival, yet majority discipline and scarcity of scrutiny time often convert control into formal ratification.

Strength in instruments: Article 75(3) permits no-confidence removal; questions, motions and debates force explanation. Articles 112-114 require financial disclosure, grant voting and appropriation. Ordinary Bills need bicameral consent; DRSCs provide detailed ministry scrutiny; PAC-CAG review closes the audit loop. Rajya Sabha adds continuity and Articles 249/312.

Weakness in use: The Tenth Schedule discourages independent voting; government controls most business; disruption reduces Question Hour; the guillotine passes demands without debate; Bill referral is optional; ordinances and contested Money Bill routing compress scrutiny. Speaker-linked defection and certification powers create neutrality concerns.

Counter-evidence: Committee consensus, opposition-led PAC work, judicial review and public debate can alter policy even when the government wins every vote. Weakness varies with coalition arithmetic and institutional leadership.

Reform: create a predictable sitting calendar; protect questions and opposition time; make committee referral the default with reasoned urgency exceptions; strengthen research/action-taken review; narrow the whip to confidence/core supply; require timely, reasoned presiding-officer decisions.

Verdict: The constitutional hardware remains sound; political incentives and procedural time are the failing software. Reform should activate existing accountability before inventing new devices.

Examiner comment: Covers instruments, causal limits, counterevidence and a prioritised reform package within the directive.

Why this earns marks: Eight named evidence units and a memorable but qualified hardware/software verdict.

How to improve this answer: Rank reforms by the diagnosed cause: time, information, referral and whip. In a shorter answer retain four instruments, four constraints and three matched remedies.